

Backup Policy & Standards

3-2-1 backup rules, retention, and restore testing (PR.DS, RC.RP)

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Standard: 3-2-1 (+ immutability)

Every covered system maintains at least three copies of data, on two different media/platforms, with one copy offsite — implemented via iDrive cloud backup plus local/image copies where contracted. Where the platform supports it, offsite copies use retention protections that prevent silent deletion (deleted-file retention, versioning, and account MFA), because attackers target backups first.

Coverage and Schedules

Workload	Method	Frequency	Retention (default)
Servers (on-prem)	Image-level backup (bare-metal recoverable)	Nightly; critical DBs more frequent per RPO	30 daily, 12 monthly
Workstations (where contracted)	File/folder backup of user data paths	Continuous or daily	30 versions / 30 days
Microsoft 365 (Exchange, OneDrive, SharePoint, Teams)	Third-party M365 backup — native retention alone is NOT backup	Multiple times daily	1 year minimum
Network configs	Firewall/switch config export	On change + monthly	12 versions
OpsPilot / internal systems	Server snapshots + database dumps offsite	Nightly	30 days + monthly archives

Security of Backups

- Encryption in transit and at rest; private-key encryption enabled where offered — keys escrowed in the vault as Restricted data.
- Backup console protected by MFA and unique admin accounts; access limited and logged.
- Backup credentials are NOT domain admin credentials; repositories are not browseable as open network shares.
- Deletion/retention changes alert the service desk.

Monitoring and Restore Testing

- Backup jobs are monitored daily; failures are ticketed and resolved within one (1) business day; two consecutive failures escalate to a senior engineer.
- Restore tests: monthly file-level test per client; quarterly full-VM/image or application-level test on a rotating schedule; results recorded (what, when, duration, success).
- Annual recovery-time validation against DR plan RTOs for Tier 1 systems.

- An untested backup is a hope, not a control — test results appear in client QBRs.

Client Responsibilities

- Identify all data locations (new apps, new shares) so coverage stays complete.
- Fund storage growth; approve retention settings; report data-loss events immediately (versioned recovery windows are finite).